since the Williamsburg summit. Their report is due in June. I proposed that we wait for that report and then see what further is needed. He's not satisfied with that and wants to tie a monetary meeting to any trade talks. I briefed him also on our Strategic Defense Initiative and sensed a reluctance on his part as to any participation in this. Then it was back to Schloss Gymnisch where I had a meeting with our solid ally Margaret Thatcher. This was a half hour, mainly spent in discussing the upcoming meeting. Back to the helicopter and off to Schloss Augustberg to meet Helmut, attend a reception, which was jammed. [Later] Back in a motorcade and off to Schloss Falkenbust for the Economic Summit dinner meeting. During the course of dinner I told them how successful Nancy's anti-drug session with seventeen other first ladies had been and by the time I finished they picked up on it and we voted to move together on a program of cooperation in dealing with the drug problem.

May 3

The Summit really begins. Let me interject that in all our motoring the streets are lined with people clapping, waving, cheering . . . all, I'm sure, to let me know they don't agree with the continuing sniping about the upcoming visit to Bitburg. The meeting was going pretty well with consensus on most of the points that would wind up in the final statement. Then we came to the matter of an early 86 round of trade talks. President Mitterrand expressed his own opposition to protectionism, but absolutely refused to agree to an early 86 round of trade talks to further reduce or eliminate protectionist measures that presently exist. We're all guilty of some. His big hang up is the fact that France subsidizes its agriculture so they can compete in export trade at lower than world market prices.